cultural figures who were compelled or summoned to Cold War Berlin made observations in and around the American sector of West Berlin and in cultural and political venues in East Berlin. They more broadly reflected on transnational American presence and power while seeking to learn from East and West Germans in adaptive and unforeseen ways. Kennedy joined them, briefly and unwittingly, by referring to the Wall as a point of reflection for domestic divisions. His utterance of "a wall of our own" is a forgotten rhetorical landmark on a larger geopolitical map of the United States.

Among these early observers who recognized the intersection of multiple dividing lines by the Berlin Wall was Jewish and white American photojournalist Leonard Freed, who attempted to make sense of the Wall while capturing overlapping points of German history in late August 1961, days after the city was divided. Freed was first drawn to Berlin by his own Jewish heritage, as he documented the return of Jewish communities and public memory in post-Holocaust Germany. However, his chance encounter with an unnamed African American soldier guarding the newly erected Berlin Wall inspired another ambitious project: mapping lines and lineages of racial segregation back home.

As Freed would observe across multiple trips to Cold War Berlin, the Wall was never a solitary structure that cut through the built environment with a simple line. Instead, the border included a patchwork of widespread fortifications consisting of alarmed fencing, hinterland walls, guard dogs, searchlights, watchtowers, countersurveillance, and a no-man's-land at the point of no return, known as the "death strip." Freed accounted for the Wall's transnational character and charge, informed not simply by its formidable physical imprint, but also by the social implications of convergence in a city that hosted two newly separated nations of Germans, Western allied military forces, Eastern bloc authorities, and the city's wave of other Cold War Berliners from Turkey, Vietnam, Cuba, and additional sites of connected conflict. In other words, the Wall's force reached well beyond the immediate scope of the border itself. Freed, too, witnessed antiblack segregation in the United States operating in analogous terms. When in the United States, as a traveling white photographer, he sought scenes of racial injustice and meaning-making. Freed viewed divided Berlin and the United States as focal points for his companion photobooks *Black in White America* (1967/68) and *Made in Germany* (1970), each of which